

A MASTER'S STROKES
'Landscape of Dewas' and (below) an untitled painting by Afzal Pathan

▲ EXHIBITION

THE PATH LESS TRAVELLED

A POSTHUMOUS EXHIBITION REINSTATES AFZAL PATHAN IN THE CANON OF MODERN INDIAN ART

The Raza Foundation, in collaboration with Triveni Kala Sangam, will present a solo exhibition of works by Afzal Pathan (1936-2000), a distinctive yet little-known figure of Indian modern art. Curated by Akhilesh, the exhibition opened with a preview on June 30 and continues until July 10 at the Shridharani Art Gallery, Triveni Kala Sangam, Delhi.

Born in Dewas, Madhya Pradesh, Pathan emerged from circumstances far removed from the metropolitan art centres that shaped much of India's post-Independence artistic discourse. Raised in a family of modest means, he developed an early interest in drawing, sketching with coal on the walls of his home. Despite financial hardship, he pursued art while working as a labourer before becoming an art teacher and later entering higher education. Although he studied at the Indore School of Art and received a gold medal from Vikram Vishwavidyalaya, Ujjain, Pathan spent most of his life in Dewas.

"There are two types of artists," he says. "Those who live in metro cities and have all facilities regarding art. The others live in small towns. They silently paint and enjoy the creativity." He notes that Pathan had only a handful of exhibitions during his lifetime.

Pathan's practice ranged from landscape and portraiture to rangoli and abstraction. Working with unconventional materials and experimental mixtures of paint and thinners, he developed a highly personal visual language. The exhibition forms part of the Raza Foundation's continuing programme of presenting significant artistic practices. ■

—Nikhil Sardana

On view at Triveni Kala Sangam, Delhi, till Jul. 10



The Listicle

What's hot and happening in the world of art this month

▼ **JUL. 10-AUG. 1** | ***DAG,*** *New Delhi*

PRINCES & PEOPLE OF INDIA

This exhibition revisits the remarkable visual record created by Emily Eden during her travels through India in the late 1830s. Featuring a complete set of lithographs from *Portraits of the Princes and People of India* alongside letters, sketchbooks and archival materials, the show offers a fascinating glimpse into the Punjab of Maharaja Ranjit Singh, while reflecting on the complexities of colonial observation and representation.



